

7.6

Persuasion 2

A Say all the sentences below *without* the words in brackets.

- 1 (It seems to me that) four months is (a bit) optimistic.
- 2 Our prices are (relatively) more expensive, but (I think that) the quality justifies the (small) additional cost.
- 3 (Actually,) our reputation in the industry is (extremely) good.
- 4 (To some extent) our share price is (a little) overvalued, but I don't think it's a significant factor.
- 5 (Of course) every company has suffered from the recent recession, but (on the whole I feel) we have done (very) well to maintain our market share at 10%.

Now say the sentences again, this time *with* the words in brackets. What is the effect?

B Study the sentences below. First identify the main idea. Then put brackets round extra words and phrases that are just used to emphasize and minimize this main idea.

- 1 We've had a very good year, in fact we've had an excellent year.
- 2 There is some truth in that, but I feel that you're exaggerating a little.
- 3 Perhaps we'll go just a bit over budget, but I'm 100% certain that we'll get the job done.
- 4 In relation to inflation, I tend to think the outlook is quite good.
- 5 Basically, our economy is healthy – very healthy.
- 6 Next year we'll recruit substantially more graduates, and what's more, they'll come from the local markets where we operate.

C Write a short presentation on any subject you feel strongly about. Practise using a variety of techniques to persuade your audience that you are right.

Emphasizing a point (giving it more importance)

<u>Emphasizing a point</u>	<i>Actually, ... In fact, ... Basically, ... To put it simply, ...</i>
<u>Adding a second point</u>	<i>What's more, ... Besides (that), ... In addition (to that), ...</i>
<u>Repeating more strongly</u>	<i>It's fast. In fact, it's one of the fastest on the market</i>

Minimizing a point (giving it less importance)

<u>Minimizing a point</u>	<i>I think ... I feel ... I tend to think ... It seems to me that ...</i>
<u>Using 'but' as a balance</u>	<i>To some extent ..., but ... Perhaps ..., but on the whole ...</i>

Emphasizing/minimizing nouns

- ++ *a substantial* (investment) *a considerable* (risk) *a major* (decision)
- + *a significant* (factor) *an important* (opportunity)
- *a small* (mistake) *a slight* (difference of opinion) *a bit of a* (change)

Emphasizing/minimizing comparative adjectives

- ++ *substantially/considerably/much* (more expensive)
- + *significantly/relatively* (cheaper)
- *marginally/a little/slightly* (smaller)